

Supporting Community Life Engagement Outcomes & Pathways to Employment



Macs CEO & Leadership Conference
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Today's Agenda

National data context

Defining community life engagement (CLE)

Updated holistic models of support

About ICI UMass resources and toolkits

Community life engagement guideposts

Provider practices in action

Questions & answers

Introductions

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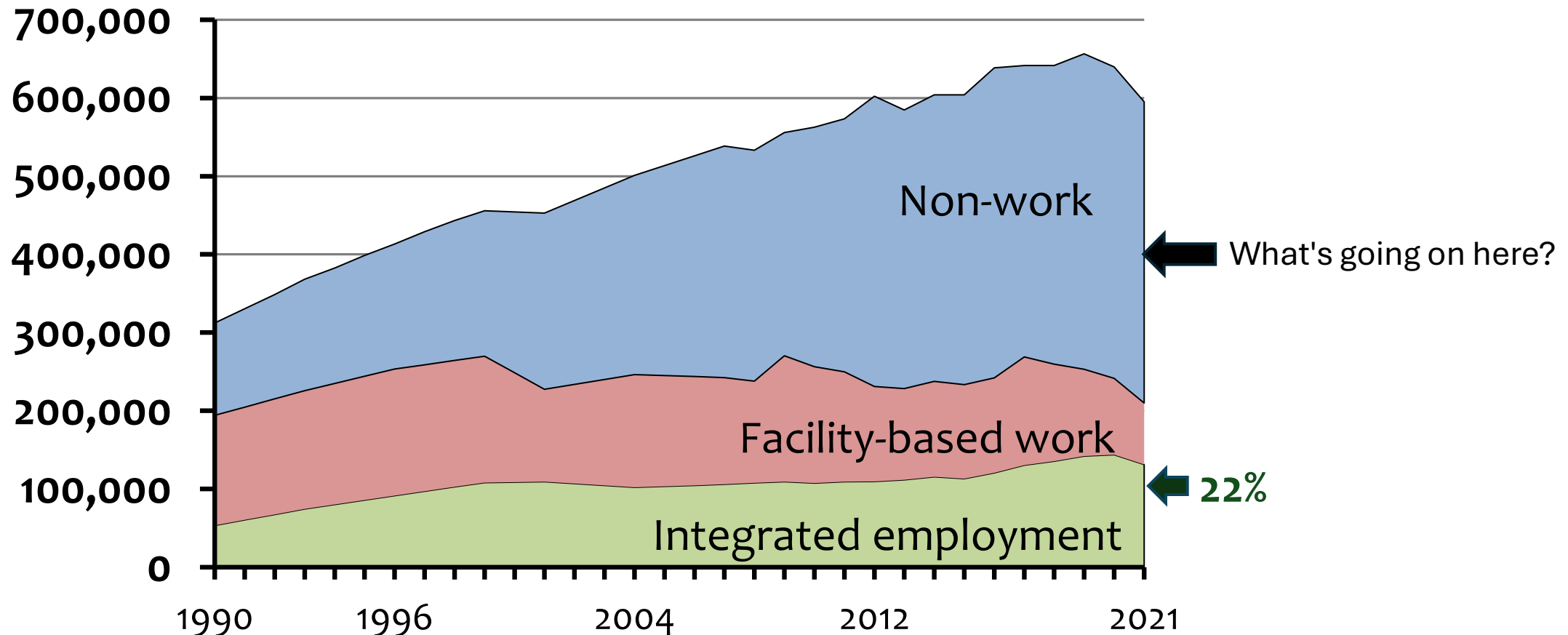
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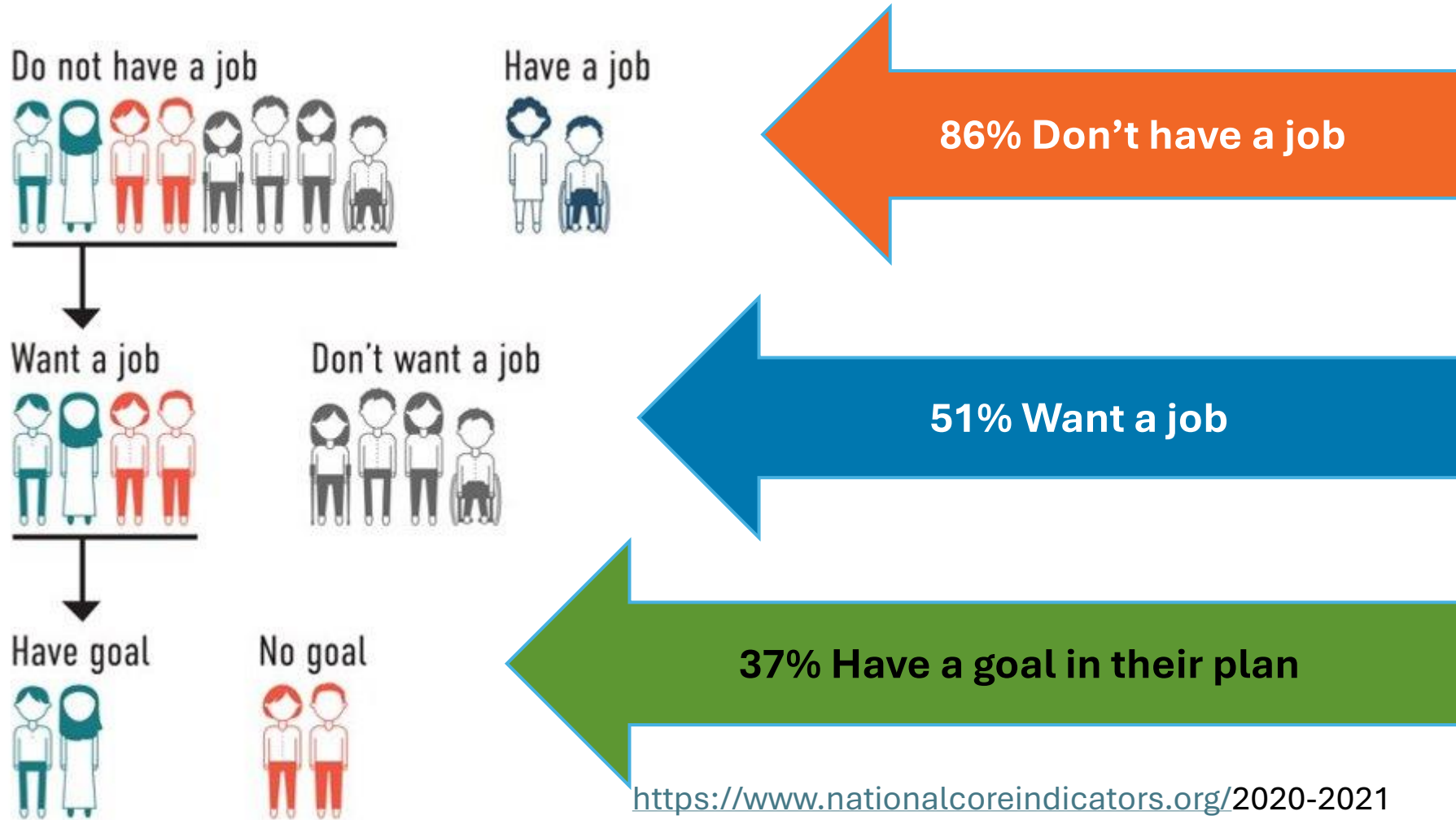


Number in Employment and Day Services



Source: [ICI National Survey of State IDD Agencies](#) www.Statedata.info

What does the Data say?



What's happening in Maryland?



MARYLAND DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH
Developmental Disabilities Administration



Activity	Number of Individuals in Activity	Percent of Individuals in Activity
Individual Competitive Job	2,398	27.6
Individual Contracted Job	215	2.5
Group Integrated Job	232	2.7
Facility Based/Sheltered Job	86	1.0
Self Employment	23	0.3
Community Based Non Work	4,539	52.2
Volunteer Job	1,561	17.9
Facility Based Non Work	3,842	44.2
No Activity Participation	888	10.2
Unduplicated Total	8,700	

Data from May 2024:

https://statedata.thinkwork.org/mdda/charts/activity_2.php

Siloing between employment & day: unintended consequences

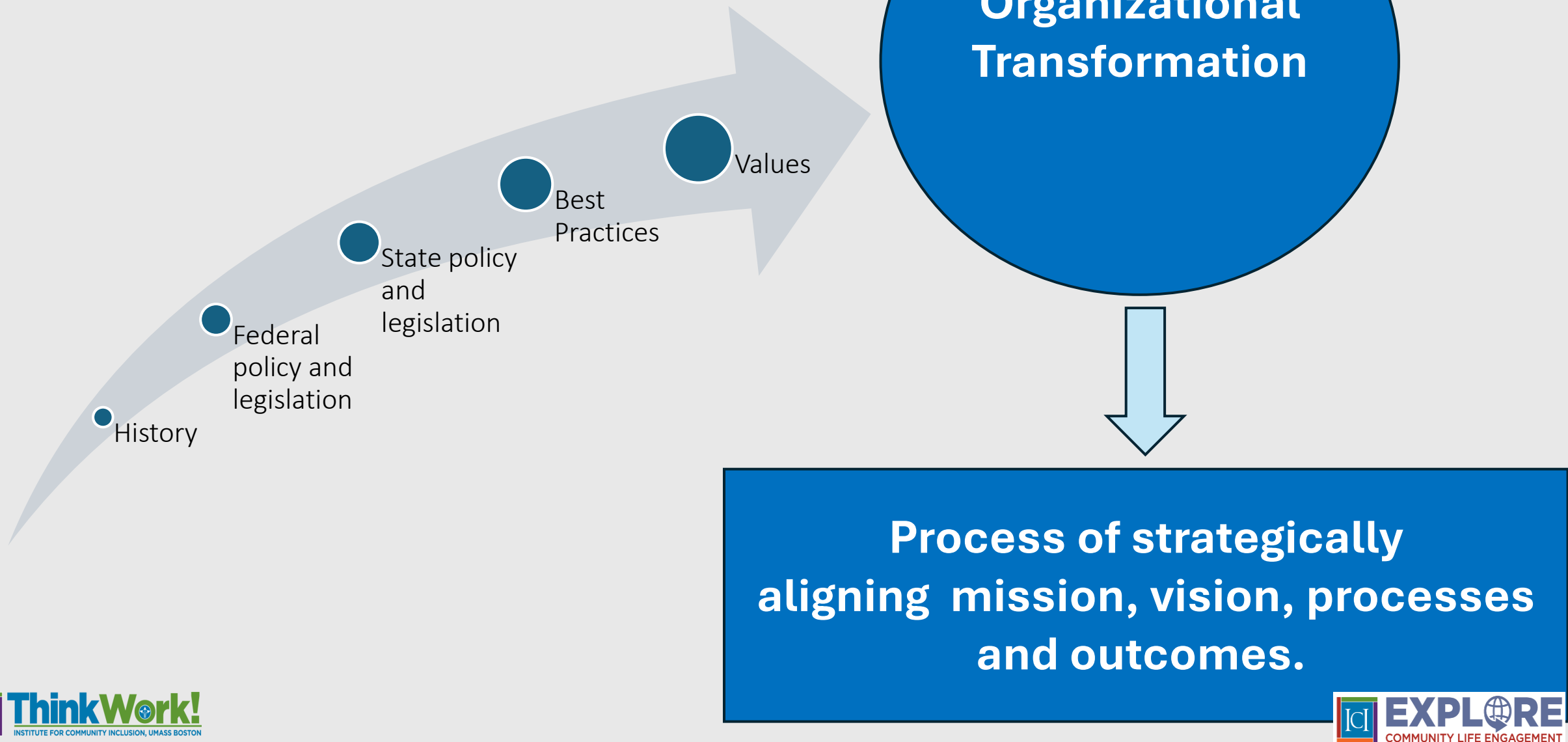
- Different values, vision, culture & expectations
- Lack of flexibility
- Different expectations
- Communication gaps and/or confusion
- Limited resources
- Duplication of efforts
- Program-centered vs. Person-centered
- Lack of movement toward employment
- ***Only looking at one part of a person***



Characteristics of updated service models

- Individualized & flexible
- Integrated & community-based
- Blended services vs programs
- Employment First philosophy and practices
- Prioritize competitive, integrated employment (CIE)
- Wrap around community life engagement (CLE)
- Outcome oriented
- Active, individualized job development process
- ***Holistic!***

Why transformation?

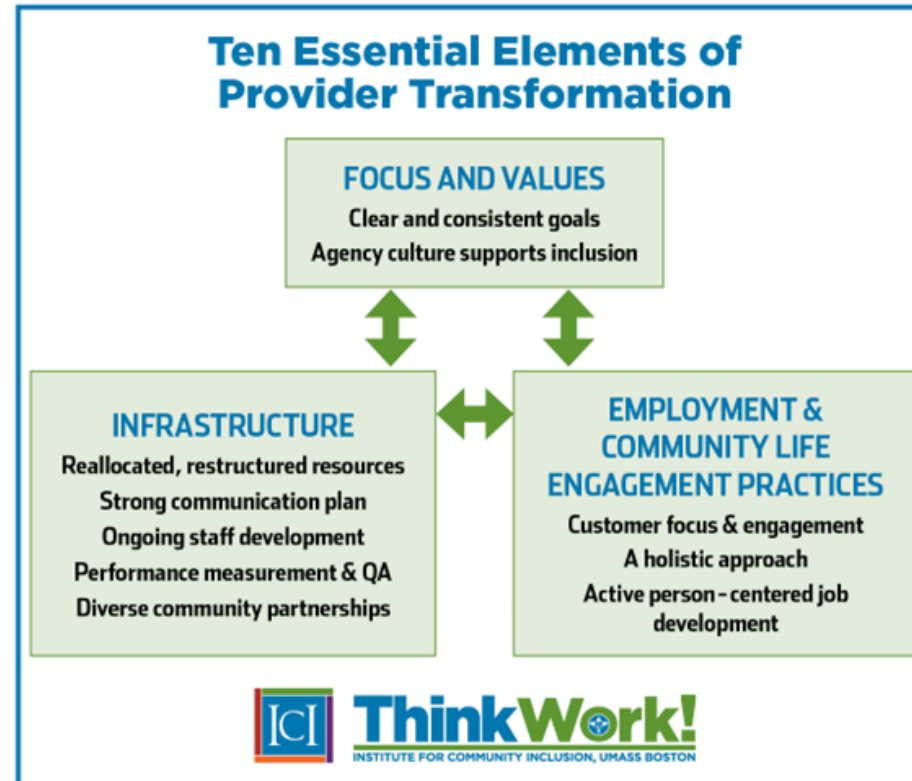




<https://cletoolkit.communityinclusion.org/>

- Resources
- Briefs
- Provider promising practices
- Fidelity scale
- Virtual learner course

ICI's Research & Toolkits



<https://www.thinkwork.org/>

Course #1: Available Now

Online CLE Training Course



Your staff help people with disabilities discover what's meaningful to them, set important life goals, and develop a path toward achieving their goals. Our self-paced, online training course, **Introduction to Community Life Engagement**, can help your staff build their skills and feel more confident in their role as direct support professionals working in the community.

Introduction to Community Life Engagement

- Lesson 1: Using a Person-Centered Approach to Support Community Life Engagement
- Lesson 2: Supporting Outcomes in Community Life Engagement
- Lesson 3: Mapping Resources for Community Life Engagement
- Lesson 4: Developing Relationships & Building Natural Supports for Community Life Engagement

Course #2: In Development

Employment and Community Life Engagement: Supporting Holistic Agency Change

Community Life Engagement Fidelity Scale[©]

January 2020

The Fidelity Scale is designed to help providers of day services for individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) determine their strengths and areas for improvement in supporting individuals' community life engagement. Community life engagement refers to access and participation in the community through inclusive and meaningful activities such as volunteer work, continuing education, and recreation. For more information and the research behind this scale see: <https://cletoolkit.communityinclusion.org/>

The Fidelity Scale should be completed by staff and management who have a familiarity with the day services and supports offered by the provider.

Respond to the following statements based upon how your [non-work] day services and supports are currently structured.

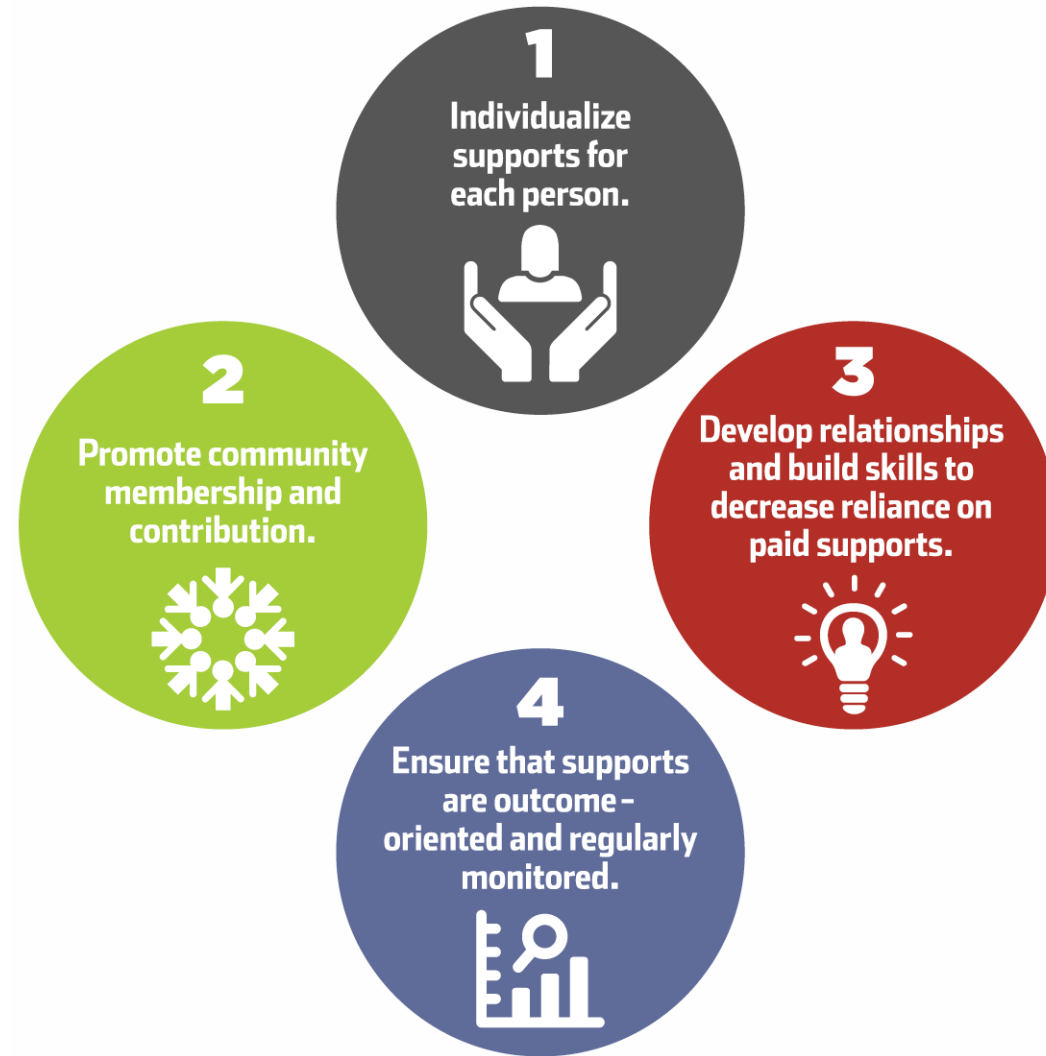
In each section, add up the numbers you circled for each response to see where you range.

Organizational Values

Circle how much you agree the following statements apply to your organization.

Organization...	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither Disagree nor Agree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Enter Number Here
Ensure all working individuals have opportunities to explore the community	1	2	3	4	5	___
Most families are of the organization's emphasis: individualized, person-centered, community-supports	1	2	3	4	5	___
Most staff are of the organization's emphasis: individualized, person-centered, community-supports	1	2	3	4	5	___
Total for Part 1	Score Range 3-6 = Low 7-11 = Medium 12-15 = High <i>For more about Organizational Values, visit https://cletoolkit.communityinclusion.org/</i>					___

Four Guideposts for Community Life Engagement





- Show understanding of personal preferences, goals, interests, and skills
- Emphasize person-centered planning and discovery
- Consider creative grouping, staffing, and scheduling



Example

Staffing

- Team grouping-cross training – iCM ISTF support
- Schedule ideas
- Planning w/approximately 1:2; mix of 1:1; 1:4
- Supplemental funding for staff development, tools
- Community facilitation a specialized skill





- Start with inclusive settings and activities
- Ensure staff presence does not limit connections with other community members
- Place value on not just presence, but ***membership*** in the community
- Consider an individual's preferences



Example

Promote membership, contribution

- Return to new volunteering post pandemic-pathway to employment
- Steer away from group usage of recreation centers post pandemic: trainers at gyms
- Building connection in home neighborhoods (asset-based community development internal community of practice)
- Create reciprocity





- Build individuals' networks to expand their access to natural supports (networks lead to jobs)
- Fade out supports when appropriate (think employment!)
- Teach specific skills to help people access their communities and employment



Example

- Person driven technology initiative – iPad modeling: self-advocacy videos, task independence through prompts, community communication
- Local Senior Centers
- ABCD – neighborhood parties



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Ensure that supports
are outcome -
oriented and regularly
monitored.



- Emphasize goals rather than processes or attendance
- Hold CLE supports to clear expectations and guidance
- How will you know you are successful?
- ***Expect that for people of working age, that community life engagement leads to or complements employment***



New Pilots

- **Learn2Earn**

7-month

Based on federal memo to blend

First group of 6 successful

Second group of 16 more blended

- Data collection – iCM reports of PCP Goal work



New program pieces

Melding of all MD Meaningful Day funding to build employment trajectory

Community Engagement program

- Wrap around Employment
- "Traditional" trajectory

Employment Services

- One Customized Employment group
- One Supported Employment group

Simultaneously with all Services – start with the person, build cohesive team to support



Try it!

Consider the sample schedule by the Guideposts
what do you think?

Maryland Technical Assistance Project (MD TAP)

Technical Assistance Opportunities 2024

Expanding Capacity to Support Employment and Community Life Engagement Outcomes

- Partnership between ICI UMass & Maryland DDA
- Limited technical assistance available for Maryland DDA funded day and employment providers
- Customized, topical or comprehensive
- Development or expansion of employment and community life engagement outcomes
- Between now and September 2025

Reach out to Staci Jones Staci.Jones@umb.edu



Questions?

